Pupil studio resources & worksheet — Planning a gallery or exhibition inquiry

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 5 Part 1 · Big question: How do we design a structured visual inquiry plan to analyse artworks in an exhibition space?

Arrival check

When an art critic or advanced student enters an exhibition, why do they bring a prepared visual inquiry sheet instead of a blank notebook?

[ ] A prepared inquiry sheet tells you exactly what to sketch: sightlines, lighting angles, tonal maps, and surface zooms

[ ] Setting three critical questions beforehand focuses your eyes on how the artworks are built and lit

[ ] Your field sketches directly feed into your Week 7 critical review

Starter visual cues

Zone 1 (Spatial & Sightline map): Floorplan/elevation showing how the focal work is framed and lit.

Zone 2 (Compositional tonal Thumbnail): 3-to-5 value sketch capturing the master contrast plan.

Zone 3 (Material & Surface close-up): Close-up study of joinery, brushstroke, or relief texture.

Zone 4 (Three critical Questions): Focused prompts testing how material and lighting choices shape meaning.

Vote: Why is a quick floorplan and lighting sketch in Zone 1 just as important as sketching the artwork itself?

Studio practice planner

Assemble your Gallery inquiry framework and critical lenses.

Shapes/Focus: Zone 1: Sightline & lighting map, Zone 2: 5-value tonal thumbnail, Zone 3: Surface & joinery close-up, Zone 4: Comparative dialogue

Tools/Methods: Question: Material vs scale, Question: Raking light impact, Question: Figure-ground tension, Question: Curatorial sequence

Exit ticket

Why do we prepare structured recording zones and critical questions BEFORE studying an exhibition?

[ ] So our observation is focused on capturing spatial layout, tonal structure, and material evidence systematically

[ ] So we do not have to look at any artworks

[ ] To fill the page before seeing the show